MORBIER PDO



THE BASICS

MAKE:	Hard
SUB MAKE:	Cheeses which acidify in the mould
POST-MAKE:	Washed rind, Wrapped, Rolled or Processed
SUB POST-MAKE:	Unflavoured wash solution, Ash (charcoal)
TYPICAL AGE PROFILE:	Three months
APPROXIMATE WEIGHT(S):	5-8kg
GEOGRAPHICAL ORIGIN:	Franche Comté
PROTECTED STATUS:	PDO - must be made with raw milk in the Ain, Doubs, Jura or Saône and Loire departments
SPECIES OF MILKING ANIMAL:	Cow
BREED OF COW:	Montbéliarde or French Simmental cows
RAW/PASTEURISED MILK:	Raw cows' milk
VEGETARIAN/ANIMAL RENNET:	Typically animal rennet
COMMONLY ENCOUNTERED VARIATIONS:	N/A

THE STORY

Produced in the Jura mountains, Morbier was historically made on farms in the winter to use up successive milkings (during the summer, milk was pooled with other farms to make Comté). The evening milk would be made into a curd loaf, which was protected overnight with a sprinkling of soot, before curd made from the morning milk was placed on top, leaving a black line running through the centre. The cheese is now made in one process all year round, but retains a black stripe of vegetable carbon as a nod to tradition. Raw milk is coagulated at below 40°C and the curd cut into 1cm cubes. The curds can also be washed. The whey is drained and the curds formed into cakes, which are sliced horizontally in half with one side dipped in charcoal, before being pressed together again. Morbier is rubbed with brine as it matures to form an orangey-pink rind.

THE CHARACTER

Beneath the fragrant dusky rind lies a supple interior and occasional small holes. The flavour is mild and milky with fruity notes. It's a great cheese for melting.

PERFECT PARTNERS:

In the Jura they drink it with the local Arbois wines, which comprise light, spicy reds, made with pinot noir, trousseau and polsard grapes, and crisp whites, made with chardonnay and savagnin.

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